CLI OPTIONS IN THE WILD

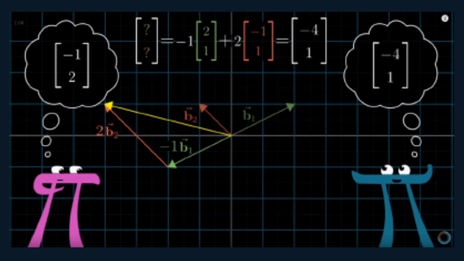
Théophile BERTHELOT, Loïs CHOW-CHINE-GALINAUD, Yoan FRANÇOIS
and **Baptiste GUERIF**

supervised by Xhevahire TËRVANA - Artishow 2026

compteur
CLI OPTION COUNTER

How many options to speed up a video?

You need an 8-second clip from *Change of Basis*, sped up and re-encoded with louder audio, for a group presentation.



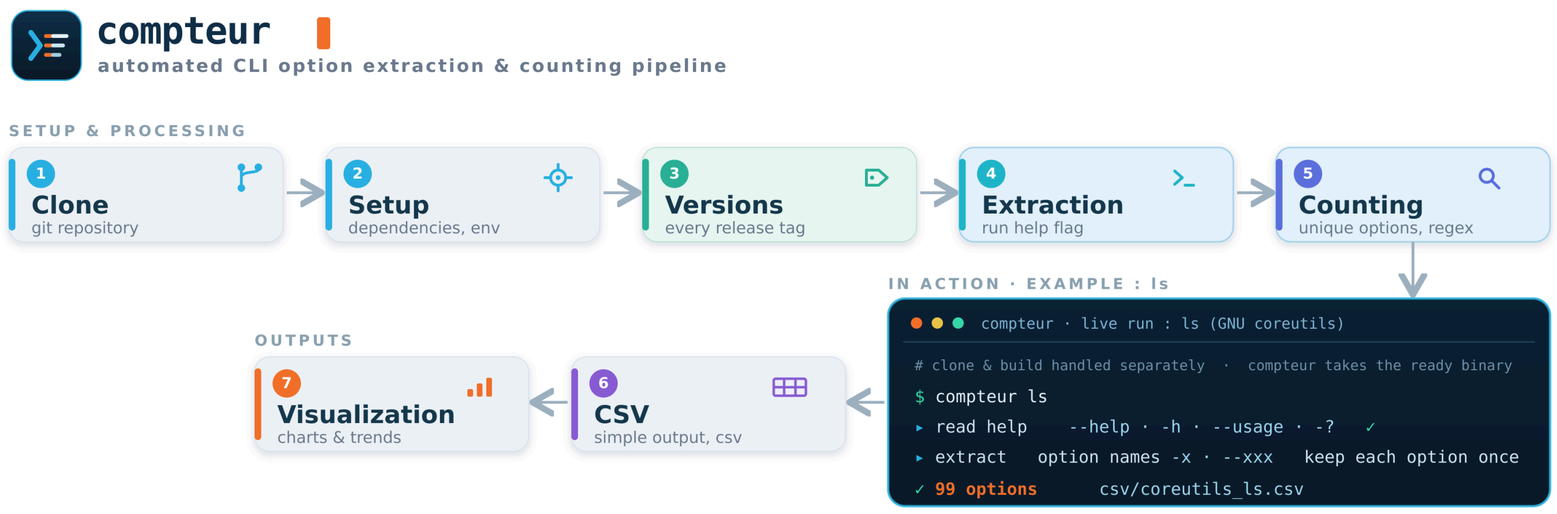
The ffmpeg command

```
$ ffmpeg -ss 00:05:12 -t 8 -i change_of_basis.mp4
-vf "setpts=0.5*PTS,scale=1280:720,eq=contrast=1.3"
-af "atempo=2.0,bass=g=10"
-c:v libx264 -preset fast -c:a aac -y clip.mp4
```

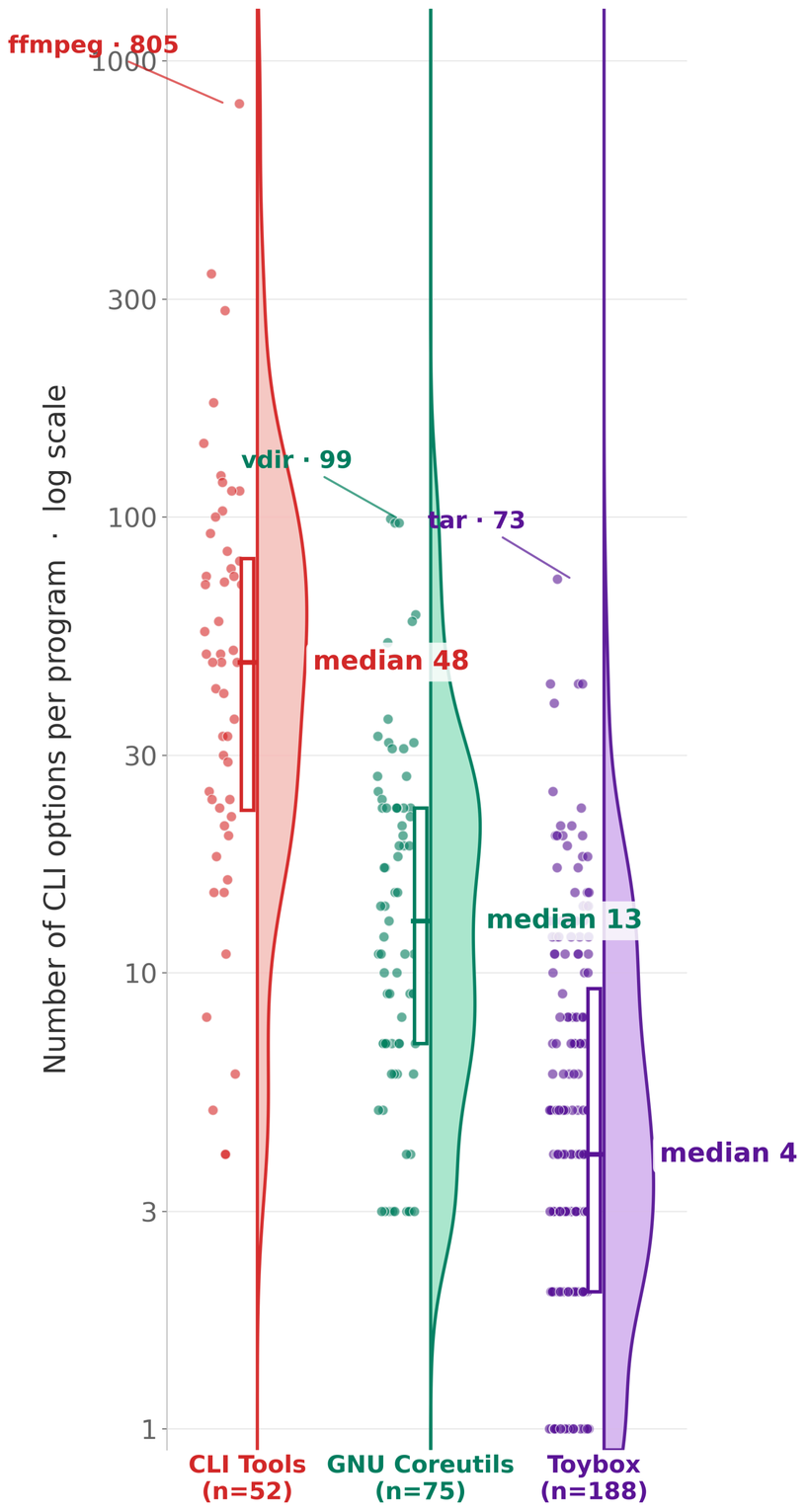
This uses **11 options**. Get one wrong and the output is **silent, black, or wrong speed**.

Think of the command-line tools you use every day, **ls**, **rm**, **git**, **curl**.
Do you know how many options they really have?
Neither did anyone else.

We built compteur, the first tool to count the number of options!



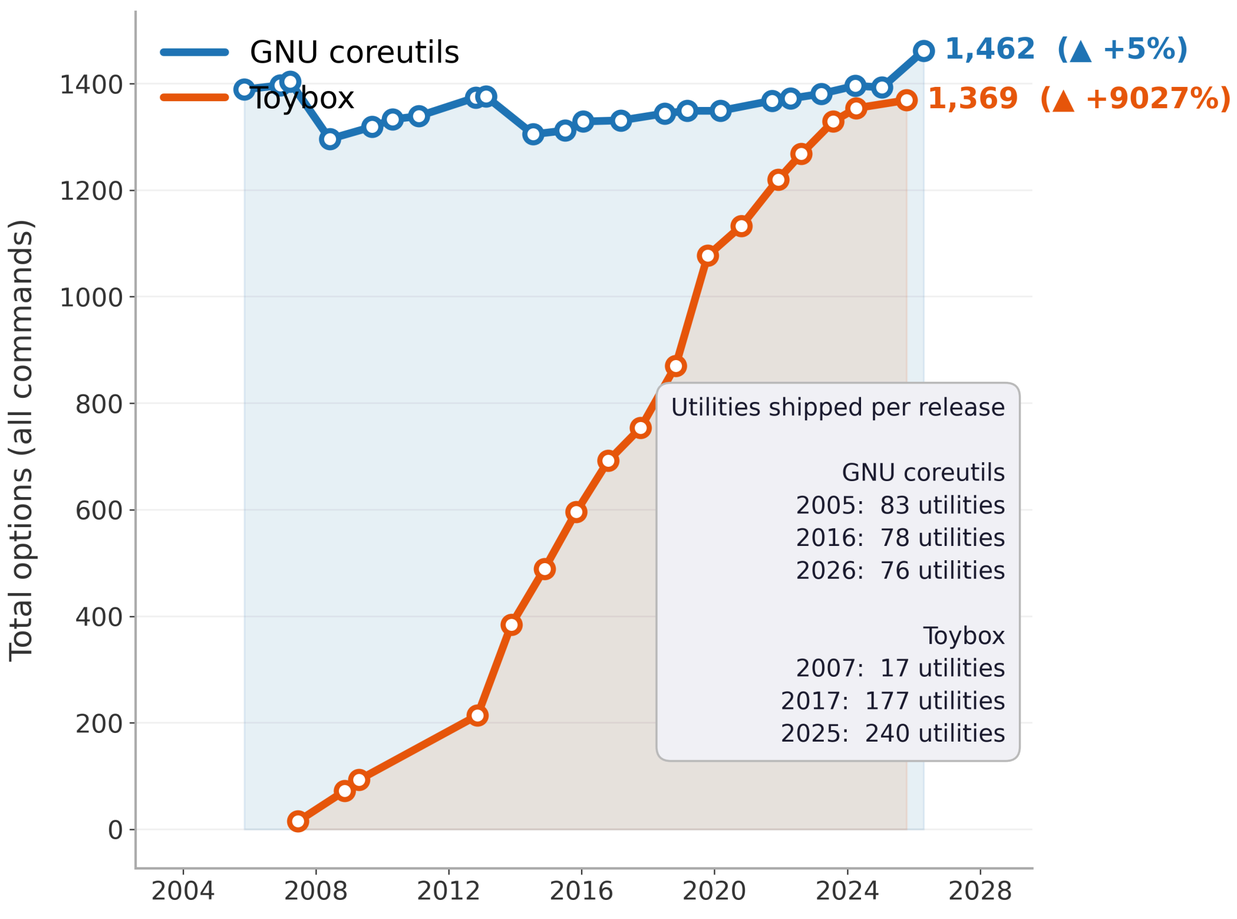
options in 315 programs



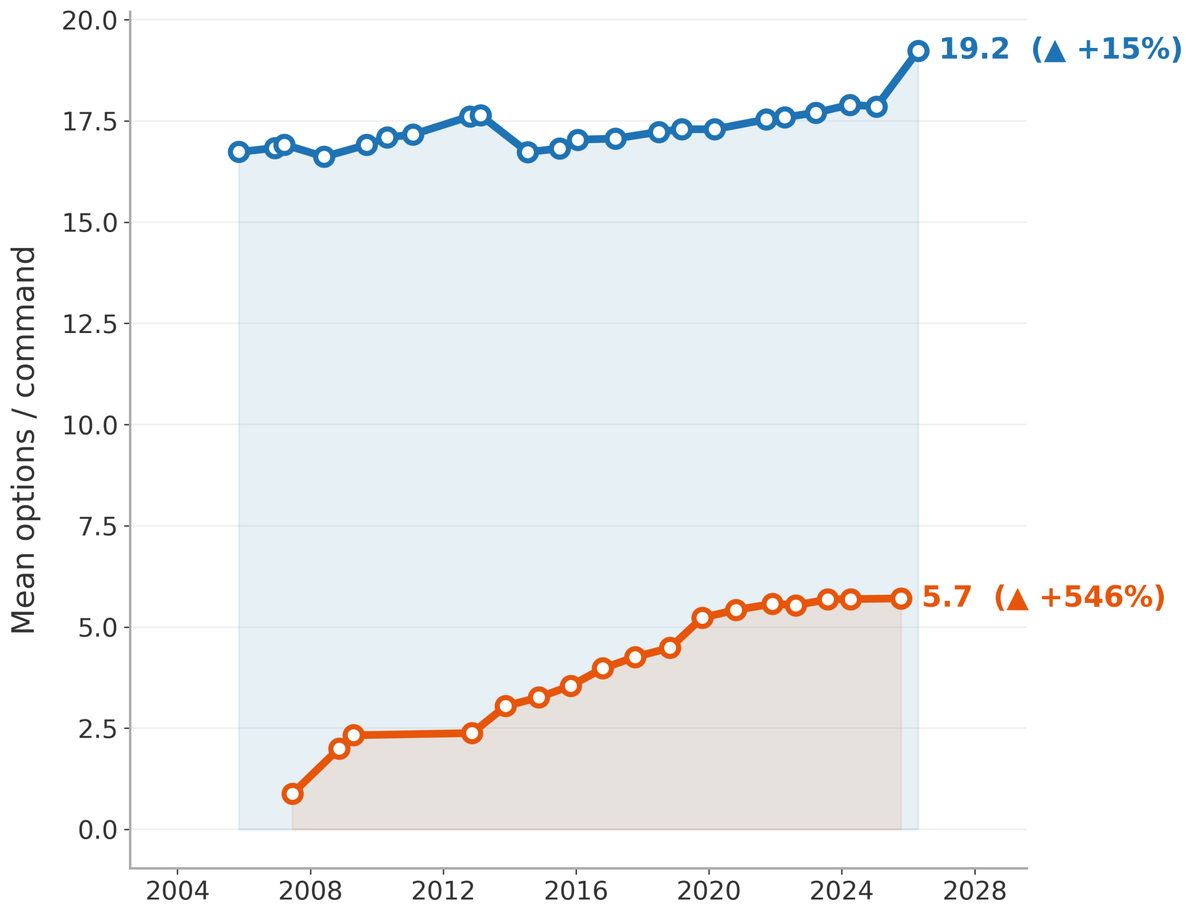
Options only grow over time

Across 20 years, every coreutils program gained options

Total option surface across the whole suite



Mean options per command



Since AI agents can build and ship features much faster than humans now, they are set to expand this option surface even further. Our **compteur** measures that growth, turning an otherwise invisible trend into data.